

Participation, promotion, and practices of the Indigenous Peoples Education (IPed)-implementing schools in localizing sustainable development goals

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ABSTRACT

This convergent parallel mixed methods study aimed to determine the participation, promotion, and practices of the elementary teachers who are serving indigenous learners in localizing the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) to empower the grassroots and nurture their potential as agents of transformative change and sustainable future in the City of Bayugan, Agusan Del Sur, Philippines towards the attainment of the development-oriented inclusive education governance. To achieve the research objective, the researchers concurrently collected and then merged the quantitative and qualitative data collected from surveys, semi-structured interviews, and focus-group discussions. Quantitative results indicated that the Indigenous People Education teachers consistently extended efforts in finding donors and sponsors to advance the learning materials to be used in the classroom. In terms of promotion, they made use of social media to disseminate information regarding the rich culture and history of the community. Also, valuing equity and equality in classroom activities and maintaining social justice and fairness have been the topmost considerations when designing instructional tools, assessing learning outcomes, managing classrooms, and applying teaching strategies. On the other hand, qualitative results revealed that establishing collaboration and partnership with private sectors is the most feasible way to fill the gap in providing quality education. Participants also highlighted the relevance of reading intervention programs to make learners functionally literate. Both quantitative and qualitative data results manifested a convergence, which means that IPed teachers have a commendable goal orientation and high commitment to empowering the Indigenous Peoples by making them active participants and contributors to the attainment of SDGs.

1. Introduction

Translating the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development at the local level is imperative to address developmental issues and problems that are predominantly rooted in marginalized and vulnerable communities (Peredo, 2020), most notably among the indigenous groups (Hirai, 2015; Sivacolundhu, 2007). The most pressing problems involving indigenous peoples are

mainly attributed to the ineffective implementation of inclusive education (Victor & Yano, 2016), as difficulty in accessing education for indigenous learners has remained a major socio-educational and development-related concern (Buenafior et al., 2023). Indigenous communities still face multiple barriers to education (Guide, 2014); as a result, they have viewed education with less importance on achieving a sustainable future.

In the Philippines, while much work has been done aligned with the provision of inclusive education (Cucio & Roldan, 2020; Shutaleva et al., 2023), the issue lies in sustainability, particularly in achieving Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs). The Department of Education, through its Indigenous Education Program (IPed), has galvanized its commitment to inclusive education as it provides equitable educational opportunities and appropriate learning environment to all marginalized learners who mostly live in far-flung areas of the country espoused in SDG 4 - Quality Education. To effectively implement the provisions enshrined in the said program, all IPed-implementing schools need adequate learning resources, infrastructure, indigenized curriculum, and stakeholder support (Bangcas et al., 2022; Villaplaza, 2021).

Additionally, these IPed-implementing schools employ community-based strategies to address school-level challenges in implementing IPed, which is essential for reducing the knowledge divide and educational inequity in the country's present educational system. For instance, teachers sought constant help and assistance from community elders and parents to support the education of indigenous learners (Jacob et al., 2018). Such a practice is commonly done by IPed teachers to establish a strong relationship with the indigenous communities they serve.

In contemporary times, despite these efforts, indigenous learners are still struggling to enjoy their right to appropriate, equitable, relevant, and quality education because of the lack of access to safe, inclusive schools. Moreover, they fail to see the relevance of education since it is difficult for them to get jobs in mainstream society due to social stigmatization (Barelli, 2014). These cases may fail to accelerate and advance the roles of the IPs in the achievement of SDGs, a purpose-driven and collaborative development commitment of most countries worldwide.

Yuan et al. (2021) underscored that education is a crucial component of the realization of SDGs. Consequently, the IPed-implementing schools have essential roles in framing the effective implementation of quality education so the learners can acquire critical life skills and enhance their capacity to pursue SDGs (United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization, 2018). Lack of access to quality education can be linked to poverty, unemployment, and other societal problems (Isakova et al., 2011; Mihai et al., 2015) which are constraints for the attainment of SDGs.

The role of teachers should not only be confined to the school level. As one of influential members of the community, teachers can accelerate the localization of SDGs by propelling students to immerse themselves in activities that foster personal and community development. They can utilize inclusive mechanisms in achieving social transformations by empowering learners, parents, and other stakeholders to work with them toward addressing school-related concerns and other gnawing issues within the community. Through community extension services, teachers may transform vulnerable groups into respectable citizens of their communities. Teachers may participate in extension areas such as environmental management, health and nutrition, livelihood generation, good governance, and education (Bidad & Campiseño, 2010). These areas are relevant to breaking the cycle of poverty, which is the primary target of SDGs.

Drawing from these perspectives, IPed teachers are considered agents for empowering indigenous learners to become active contributors to securing a sustainable future by incorporating inclusive and participatory school-level management activities that localize sustainable development goals.

With these, this study aimed to achieve the following research objectives:

Research objectives:

1. Determine the participation, promotion, and practices of IPed-implementing schools in localizing SDGs.
2. Analyze the perceptions and experiences of the teachers and other educational stakeholders on the participation, promotion, and practices of IPed-implementing schools in localizing SDGs.
3. Examine the extent of convergence and divergence of quantitative and qualitative results.

2. Literature review

2.1. Localizing sustainable development goals: Issues and challenges

The process of localizing Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) has been accompanied by a number of challenges. Krantz and Gustafsson (2021) explored an integrated approach to localizing SDGs; however, such an approach was confronted by several obstacles related to budgets, leadership, and coordination. They assert that SDG localization requires political support and inclusivity.

Similarly, Oosterhof (2018) identified the key factors that affect SDG localization efforts. In his paper, he underscored the limited financial resources to support the localization in Armenia. Consequently, such a factor adversely affects the country's economic and social development process. Likewise, the absence of SDG localization in national planning is another contributing factor.

Tiwari et al. (2021) found that adopting Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) at the local level in India is not a priority. One of the common problems in the local communities in India is public transport, which is one of the SDG targets. They revealed that local governments did not prioritize public transport planning. Thus, to address this issue, a bottom-up approach should be employed. Moreover, they accentuated that the municipalities should include SDGs as part of their outcome-based budget.

In Tanzania, Jönsson and Bexell (2021) stated that the SDG localization efforts of political institutions are lacking. In their study, they enumerated the challenges to localization, which include citizens' low awareness of SDGs, lack of knowledge and coordination, and limited resources.

The above findings were supported by the study of Perry et al. (2021). They revealed that low levels of local awareness limit the localization of the SDGs. The translation of SDGs must be based on what the locals need. They pointed out the ambivalence of the local authorities to localize the goals, attributed to the practices of governance and knowledge politics. As such, the need for coordination and resources must be considered. In the process of translation, SDG localization necessitates time and resources.

2.2. Implementation of inclusive education for indigenous peoples

One of the central tenets of SDGs is the promotion of inclusive education. In the international context, Burn (2019) presented the stories of indigenous education Leads to implementing a policy framework that responds to the cultural needs of indigenous students across Canada. As policy enactors, the Leads conveyed the significance of the framework to integrate indigenous knowledge and practices into the K-12 curriculum; thus, it was seen as a means for bringing about transformative change. It involves recognizing and respecting Indigenous students' unique cultural, linguistic, and social backgrounds while promoting their full participation in mainstream educational systems. This approach emphasizes the importance of Indigenous knowledge and traditions within the curriculum and the hiring and training of Indigenous teachers and educational leaders. Moreover, inclusive education for Indigenous Peoples necessitates collaboration between governments, Indigenous communities, and educational institutions to develop culturally relevant curricula, provide adequate resources, and foster a welcoming and supportive learning environment. It is not only a matter of education but also a means of preserving Indigenous cultures, languages, and identities, promoting social cohesion, and ultimately contributing to the empowerment and self-determination of Indigenous Peoples. However, as surfaced in the findings, there is still a dire need for schools and educators to respond to the needs of the indigenous communities.

In Asia, Errico (2017) reported that approximately 260 indigenous peoples live there. The gnawing concern about the indigenous peoples across Asian countries is that they remain to be the poorest of the poor. In his paper, he stressed the need for a human rights-based overview of policy frameworks in line with the 1989 ILO Indigenous and Tribal Peoples Convention and the UN Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples (UNDRIP). This human-rights-based overview must focus on the indigenous peoples' rights, promote consultation and participation, and protect their land and natural resources. In terms of indigenous peoples' education, countries across Asia have considered implementing mother tongue-based bilingual education and teaching indigenous languages in response to issues such as illiteracy and high drop-out rates (Errico, 2017).

In the Philippines, national laws and policies have been implemented to support the provision of inclusive education for indigenous peoples. The government passed the Indigenous Peoples Rights Act (IPRA) or the Republic Act 8371, which recognizes and protects the Indigenous peoples' rights in the country (Episcopal Commission on Indigenous Peoples, 2008). This includes the indigenous peoples' right to education.

In fact, the Department of Education (DepEd) strengthened the support for IPed through DepEd Order No. 62, series 2011, which mandates the adoption of the National Indigenous Peoples Education (IPed) Policy Framework (Villaplaza, 2021). In addition, to provide inclusive education for indigenous peoples, the DepEd adopted the Indigenous People Participation Framework (IPPF) in line with the DepEd Order No. 62, s. 2011 and the country's pursuit of achieving SDGs (Department of Education, 2020).

2.3. The role of IPed-Implementing schools in achieving sustainable development goals

The SDGs are highly relevant to indigenous peoples, as millions of them suffer from hunger and poverty and are deprived of other basic social services (International Fund for Agricultural Development, 2016). Indigenous peoples are main actors in protecting and stewarding ecosystems; their food systems can positively contribute to food security and nutrition. Recognizing indigenous knowledge, systems, and practices can contribute to the

achievement of SDGs, which can be augmented by providing culturally inclusive schools for indigenous peoples.

Manuel and Queroda (2018) conducted a study about the implementation of the IPed Policy Framework at a basic educational institution in Pangasinan, Philippines. They indicated in their study the crucial role of the school as it is at the forefront of the implementation of the IP Education Program. The school ensures the provision of inclusive education among IPs, which aligns with SDG 4. Moreover, Oxtero (2022) stated that IPed-implementing schools have a significant role in implementing the IPed programs. They serve as a strong impetus to increase the participation of indigenous peoples in community development, thus contributing to the achievement of SDGs.

As Cerdeña (2008) revealed in her paper, the foundation of a cultural education center in Mindanao brought more educational opportunities for indigenous communities. With the adoption of a culture-based curriculum, the indigenous learners at the primary level strengthened their connection with their ancestral lands and continued to attend mainstream schools at the secondary level. By making education accessible to indigenous children, it would be possible for them to participate in socio-cultural development in the future actively.

Furthermore, Nasira et al. (2020) mentioned in their study that low motivation is one of the reasons why indigenous peoples do not highly regard education. They divulged that character-forming cultural values are significant in the lives of indigenous peoples. Through a customary education institution that fosters cultural values, their participation in the education process can be increased.

3. Research methodology

The researchers employed the convergent parallel mixed methods design to analyze the collected data. It was applied to determine the consistency of the responses and to provide a clearer and more accurate understanding of how the SDGs have been localized at the school level, especially in the case of IPed-implementing schools. The respondents were one-hundred thirty-one teachers from different IPed-implementing schools in the Division of Bayugan City, Agusan Del Sur, one of the school divisions that have fully implemented the provisions of the IPed program. Discussed below are the data collection and analysis procedures for quantitative and qualitative data:

3.1. Quantitative data collection and analysis

The researchers devised a survey instrument to determine the participation, promotion, and practices of IPed-implementing schools in localizing SDGs. For the participation and promotion part of the instrument, a 5-point Likert Scale showing the level of agreement was utilized, where 5 means “strongly agree”, 4 for “agree”, 3 for “moderately agree”, 2 for “slightly agree”, and 1 means “disagreement.” On the other hand, for the practices part, a 5-point Likert Scale identifies the level of frequency where 5 means “always”, 4 for “frequent”, 3 for “often”, 2 for “seldom”, and 1 means “never”.

After the instruments were retrieved from the 131 respondents, the responses were analyzed using SPSS. Descriptive statistics and frequency counts were examined. Rating scale indicating the range such as never- 1.00 - 1.79 (disagree/never), 1.80 - 2.59 (slightly agree/seldom)- 2.60 - 3.39 (moderately agree/often), 3.40 - 4.19 (agree/frequent), and 4.20 - 5.00 (strongly agree/always) was utilized to provide verbal interpretation for the results. The results were presented in the table and were supported by the related literature and studies.

3.2. Qualitative data collection and analysis

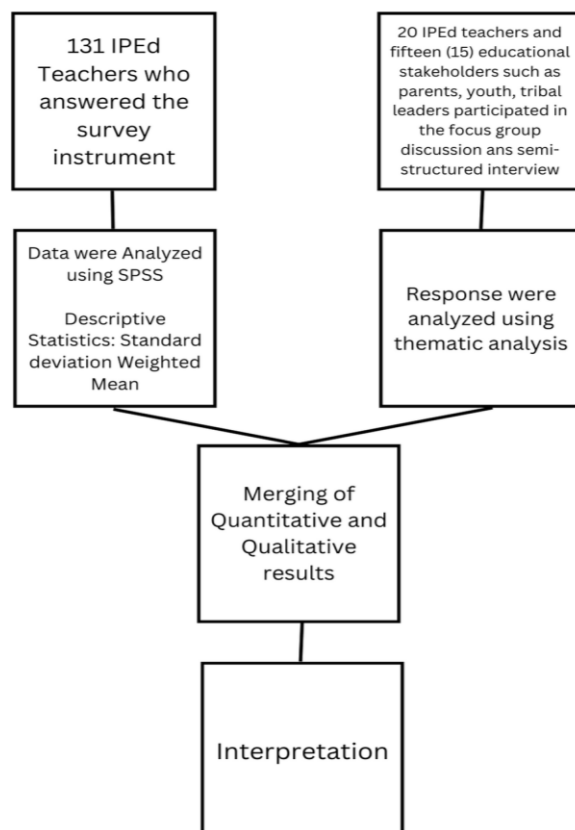
Focus-group discussions and semi-structured interviews with twenty (20) teacher-participants and fifteen (15) educational stakeholders such as parents, youth, and tribal leaders were conducted to explain their experiences and perspectives regarding the localization of SDGs in their respective schools. The 20 teachers were originally part of the respondents who answered the survey and were chosen based on the following criteria: location of the school, number of learners handled, and number of training attended, to ensure equal representation in the qualitative data collection. Responses were carefully transcribed and analyzed using the thematic analysis introduced by Braun and Clarke (2006). The discussion was further presented with field notes produced during participant observation and immersion to provide a richer result.

3.3. Merging quantitative and qualitative results

The quantitative and qualitative results were merged to determine the convergence and divergence of the collected data. By directly comparing the results drawn from one method (qualitative or quantitative) to those drawn from another method (quantitative or qualitative) for convergence or divergence, a researcher can get a more accurate picture of a research issue (Clark, 2017). The complementation and comparison of the data reveal accurate information regarding the localization of the SDGs at the school level, which may be used for educational planning, school management and policymaking, and collaborative mechanisms. Below is the figure that shows the joint collection and analysis of data following the convergent parallel mixed methods research process:

Figure 1

Convergent Parallel Mixed Methods Process



Source. The researcher's data analysis

4. Result and discussion

4.1. Determine the participation, promotion, and practices of IPed-implementing schools in localizing SDGs

Table 1 shows the participation of IPed-implementing schools in collaborating with the stakeholders. It reveals that teachers look for sponsorships to buy electronic gadgets that would help them acquaint learners with modern technology and innovation. They also collaborate with professionals, international partners, and the private sector to seek support in providing the prerequisites to achieve quality life, such as reproductive health, adequate employment opportunities, and complete infrastructure for sports and recreation. De Torres (2021) highlighted that stakeholder involvement can be translated into value formation activities, sports competitions, reduction of illiteracy among students, and assisting the school community in sourcing out funds for students.

Table 1

Participation Strategies of IPed-implementing Schools to Localize SDGs in Terms of Stakeholders' Collaboration

Indicative statement	Mean	SD	Verbal description
I forge collaboration with stakeholders and businesspersons who can provide possible employment.	3.68	1.06	Agree
I look for donors and sponsors to procure electronic tools for students.	3.93	1.03	Agree
I coordinate with health professionals and social workers to reinforce responsible parenthood and sex education.	3.89	0.98	Agree
I collaborate with private sponsors and donors to build recreational infrastructure.	3.47	1.10	Agree
I encourage international partners to improve the delivery of social services.	3.35	1.17	Moderately Agree
General Weighted Mean	3.66		Agree

Source. Data analysis result of the research

Table 2 reveals the socio-civic activities engagement of the IPed-implementing schools to localize SDGs. It can be gleaned from the table that IPed schools initiate practices that promote climate resilience and environment sustainability, such as good water quality maintenance and conversation, which is the topmost socio-civic activity in which they are engaged since there is a limited clean water resource in the community where the IPs live. Aside from that, IPed teachers are usually involved in community extension initiatives such as providing initial medical relief to sick persons by giving them medicines, conducting feeding programs, and spearheading income-generating activities for vulnerable populations. Salazar (2020) concluded that the community extension programs of the school have achieved their purpose in their community extension and engagements addressing the needs and problems of the community through different projects focusing on skills training, health education services, computer literacy, advocacy, and livelihood programs.

Table 2

Participation Strategies of IPed-implementing Schools to Localize SDGs in terms of Socio-Civic Activities Engagement

Indicative statement	Mean	SD	Verbal description
I provide medicines and supplements as medical relief for sick people.	3.93	1.08	Agree
I initiate feeding program to reduce hunger and the rate of malnutrition.	3.73	1.11	Agree
I demonstrate ways to conserve water and ways to maintain the cleanliness and sanitation of water sources.	4.17	0.95	Agree
I spearhead income-generating activities for vulnerable populations.	3.32	1.18	Moderately Agree
I initiate practices that can help preserve traditional climate change and environmental protection strategies.	3.85	1.02	Agree
General Weighted Mean	3.80		Agree

Source. Data analysis result of the research

Table 3 shows the participation of the IPed-implementing schools in community development and planning related to localizing SDGs. Community consultation of the IPed schools when crafting policies advances social cohesion and maintains a promising affiliation between two entities. In return, IPed schools help the community locate natural resources that can be used for income-generating activities, suggest preventive ways to control the spread of diseases, sustain food security, and map out cultural sites for possible tourism ventures. Coombes and Ponta (2023) pointed out that educators also create partnerships with local groups and organizations that provide services such as social and psychological interventions.

Table 3

Participation Strategies of IPed-implementing Schools to Localize SDGs in terms of Community Development and Planning

Indicative statement	Mean	SD	Verbal description
I help in identifying natural resources and possible economic and business ventures.	3.74	1.06	Agree
I forward suggestions about the ways to prevent diseases during the planning of activities.	3.72	1.08	Agree
I extend school management policies to the community to ensure peace, order, and social cohesion.	3.93	0.93	Agree
I help map out the cultural sites and places that can be used for tourism.	3.46	1.11	Agree
I participate in processing, planting, and storing Neglected and Underutilized Crop Species (NUCS) to sustain food security.	3.67	1.08	Agree
General Weighted Mean	3.70		Agree

Source. Data analysis result of the research

Table 4 reveals the institutional partnerships and linkages of the IPed-implementing schools in the localization of SDGs. Low reading comprehension is the topmost problem among indigenous learners, seriously affecting their academic performance and intellectual maturity. To address this, IPed teachers usually partner with agencies to provide feasible interventions that can improve learners' reading performance. They also share relevant knowledge about community development, innovation, and scientific discoveries with other schools, scientific agencies, and indigenous communities. Hutamares (2023) concluded that schools that had partnered with a private foundation could positively change the students' reading comprehension.

Table 4

Participation Strategies of IPed-implementing Schools to Localize SDGs in Terms of Institutional Partnership and Linkages

Indicative statement	Mean	SD	Verbal description
I collaborate with the scientific communities such as DOST, DA, and other organizations to increase learner's knowledge of science and innovation.	3.32	1.13	Moderately Agree
I partner with agencies to devise a reading intervention to lessen the number of frustrated readers.	3.74	1.09	Agree
I make a partnership with scientific communities to purchase and install solar-powered lights and equipment for consumption.	3.25	1.21	Moderately Agree
I invite non-residents to visit the community to promote tourist attractions.	3.30	1.16	Moderately Agree
I establish a promising cooperation with other schools to share and acquire best practices that drive community development.	3.61	1.12	Agree
General Weighted Mean	3.44		Agree

Source. Data analysis result of the research

Table 5 shows the promotional ways of the IPed-implementing schools in disseminating information about SDGs. As shown in the table, IPed teachers make sure to use social media to advance tourism opportunities in the community. According to Habkirk (2021), digital content can be used by educators to introduce indigenous information such as histories and worldviews. Apart from that, they also help the government cascade details on disaster risk reduction strategies, constitutional rights, sustainable consumption and waste management, and environment management.

Table 5

Ways of IPed-implementing Schools to Promote SDGs in Terms of Information Dissemination

Indicative statement	Mean	SD	Verbal description
I use social media to promote the value of indigenous communities' cultural heritage.	4.01	1.03	Agree
I inform the community about the local government's disaster risk reduction strategies.	3.93	0.88	Agree

Indicative statement	Mean	SD	Verbal description
I demonstrate the responsible ways of consumption, waste management, and production.	3.89	0.92	Agree
I safeguard the civic and political rights of the indigenous peoples by explaining to them their inherent and constitutional rights.	3.87	0.97	Agree
I share information with the community about sustainable forest management and the protection of flora and fauna.	3.77	1.22	Agree
General Weighted Mean	3.89		Agree

Source. Data analysis result of the research

Table 6 reveals the IPed-implementing schools' strategies for advancing community knowledge. IPed teachers show support in empowering science and technology in the community. They publicly discuss relevant issues that deal with their future through town hall meetings, environmental protection planning, and the conduct of training and research. These participatory mechanisms deepen the engagements and responsibilities of the stakeholders towards community empowerment. Balzan et al. (2022) concluded that social media can improve communication within the school as it has increased public awareness of the school and department activities and opened opportunities to share science-based information between learners, educators, academic experts, and the public, making science more relative and easier to access without losing its essential knowledge.

Table 6

Ways of IPed-implementing Schools to Promote SDGs in terms of Knowledge Advancement

Indicative statement	Mean	SD	Verbal description
I spearhead a town hall meeting to talk about development issues and protective strategies.	3.29	1.00	Moderately Agree
I support, whether financial or moral, indigenous learners who show potential in science and technology.	3.72	1.21	Agree
I initiated a community-based planning for marine protection and coastal ecosystem conservation.	3.15	1.30	Moderately Agree
I conduct independent research works that deal with natural resources and possible income-generating opportunities that can be derived from the ancestral domain.	2.86	1.28	Moderately Agree
I conduct training for indigenous communities regarding strategic, operational, and tactical planning that can be utilized for community development.	2.93	1.28	Moderately Agree
General Weighted Mean	3.19		Moderately Agree

Source. Data analysis result of the research

Table 7 shows the social mobilization strategies employed by the IPed schools to promote SDGs. The table accentuates that collaborative efforts with the community nurture a solid partnership to realize the large-scale objectives of SDGs. The shared expertise, knowledge, and resources among schools, governments, civil societies, non-governmental organizations, and privates offer an empowering mechanism toward national building. Also, the inclusion of vulnerable sectors such as youth and adult populations in development planning through organizations and education programs galvanizes their commitment to building an inclusive society. Thaman (2013) suggested the inclusion of indigenous community elders and members in crafting decisions, specifically in education and the development of resources in topics of culture and languages.

Table 7

Ways of IPed-implementing Schools to Promote SDGs in Terms of Social Mobilization

Indicative statement	Mean	SD	Verbal description
I create youth-serving organizations to promote and amplify the role of youth in nation-building.	3.27	1.22	Moderately Agree
I conduct adult education programs to increase the literacy rate and ability of the adult population to engage in development programs.	3.27	1.15	Moderately Agree
I provide a helping desk for vulnerable populations to tackle their issues and concerns.	3.20	1.05	Moderately Agree
I establish a mutual partnership with the community to secure their trust and loyalty.	3.62	1.12	Agree
I secure affiliations with different organizations that share the same vision of empowering indigenous learners and communities.	3.52	1.19	Agree
General Weighted Mean	3.38		Moderately Agree

Source. Data analysis result of the research

Table 8 reveals the educational initiatives delivered by the IPed-implementing schools to achieve some indicators enshrined in SDGs. It emphasizes that IPed teachers maximize the community's competence, knowledge, and skills by including them in school management. Aside from involvement, consent-seeking and social justice are also practiced and well-valued by the IPed teachers to establish rapport with the community. This also safeguards the community's individuality and diversity, leading to a more equity-oriented society. Habkrik (2021) emphasized some approaches that teach students about the contents, ideologies, and comprehensions of the indigenous cultures that surround them and valuable lessons about social justice and settler colonialism. Moreover, IPed teachers also promote the importance of biodiversity conservation in the ancestral domain and indigenous science and technology through project implementation and school-level competitions.

Table 8*Ways of IPed-implementing Schools to Promote SDGs in terms of Educational Initiatives*

Indicative statement	Mean	SD	Verbal description
I spearhead a school project that aims to protect the rich biodiversity of the community.	3.45	1.10	Agree
I supervise and reinforce implementing policies such as anti-discrimination, anti-bullying, and anti-corruption to ensure justice and equity are always followed.	3.70	1.04	Agree
I involve the community in decision-making that concerns educational management and school activities.	3.78	1.14	Agree
I spearhead competitions that emphasize the importance and utilization of indigenous science and technology to promote endogenous growth.	3.39	1.13	Moderately Agree
I secure permission from the tribal leaders regarding the conduct of school activities for appropriateness and relevance to their vision of empowerment.	3.71	1.13	Agree
General Weighted Mean	3.61		Agree

Source. Data analysis result of the research

Table 9 shows the instructional design and management practices of IPed teachers in localizing SDGs. It reveals that IPed teachers frequently promote culturally responsive teaching through the development of empowering learning materials made by local products that can be seen in their respective communities. These materials preserve indigenous science and value the richness of the communities' peculiar cultural upbringing. To successfully create such materials, IPed teachers closely work with indigenous learners to create culturally appropriate learning tools. Habkirk (2021) noted that teachers should integrate indigenous ideas into local school's curricula and lesson plans through partnerships with indigenous communities. He added that teachers should find ways to incorporate indigenous content in lessons and maintain its accuracy, advocacy, and relevance in the classrooms.

Table 9*Classroom Practices of IPed Teachers in Localizing SDGs in Terms of Instructional Design and Management*

Indicative statement	Mean	SD	Verbal description
I use non-discriminatory graphics when creating learning tools to avoid the feeling of division and intolerance of cultural differences.	4.18	0.90	Frequent
I consider the available materials in the community when designing instructional materials to emphasize the value of their natural resources in their ancestral domain.	4.15	0.85	Frequent
I promote the importance of indigenous technology and knowledge when developing instructional materials.	4.03	0.95	Frequent

Indicative statement	Mean	SD	Verbal description
I make use of their cultural symbolism and colors when designing audio-visual materials to emphasize the value of respect and inclusion.	4.00	0.89	Frequent
I get suggestions and comments from the indigenous learners regarding the instructional materials being used in teaching the lessons.	3.88	1.00	Frequent
General Weighted Mean	4.05		Frequent

Source. Data analysis result of the research

Table 10 displays the assessment and evaluation practices of the IPed teachers to cascade relevant information about SDGs. Self-check monitoring and reflective assessments are mostly practiced for the learners to present their authentic understanding of the topics and actual learning progress. Apart from these, they frequently use metacognitive questioning and visioning techniques to showcase how well learners are critically aware of the community's long-term development pathways. Furthermore, they also uncover learners' potential leadership skills through real-world tasks and activities. Al-Kuwari et al. (2021) collectively shared that teachers' involvement in designing and implementing assessments has the assurance of continuous alignment of learning and assessment with the SDGs.

Table 10

Classroom Practices of IPed Teachers in Localizing SDGs in Terms of Assessment and Evaluation

Indicative statement	Mean	SD	Verbal description
I use metacognitive questions that stimulate students' interest and reactions toward societal issues and concerns.	4.07	0.84	Frequent
I utilize the visioning technique in assessing students' expectations, desires, goals, intentions, and commitment to community development.	4.07	0.82	Frequent
I teach the ways of responsible living into some reflective questions and personal insights in determining the learner's understanding of the lessons.	4.11	0.81	Frequent
I make use of authentic assessments to help indigenous learners become responsible and leaders of their own learning.	4.05	0.85	Frequent
I allow indigenous learners to monitor their learning progress for self-growth and self-discovery.	4.21	0.85	Always
General Weighted Mean	4.10		Frequent

Source. Data analysis result of the research

Table 11 presents the classroom management practices observed by the IPed teachers to echo SDGs. The table emphasizes that the rights and subjectivity of the learners are consistently valued and respected in class, particularly in classroom policies, discipline codes, and regulations. Sharing stories and demonstrating equity in all classroom transactions that are set to inspire learners are always carried out to establish a good social relationship imbued with justice and liberal practice. Restoule and Chaw-in-is (2017) recommended building a community by

recognizing the potential in all students and members of the community as a source of knowledge. Also, to establish respect and safe spaces that are culturally focused that can ignite learners' values of honesty, listening, and silence as well as the inclusion of students in decision-making and problem-solving activities.

Table 11

Classroom Practices of IPed Teachers in Localizing SDGs in Terms of Classroom Management

Indicative statement	Mean	SD	Verbal description
I consider the indigenous rights and governance of the learners in managing the classroom so that they feel respected and valued.	4.41	0.73	Always
I consider the free will and rights of the learners in crafting classroom policies and regulations.	4.38	0.73	Always
I strengthen social relationships and rapport with the learners through sharing motivational and inspiring stories.	4.37	0.73	Always
I empower indigenous learners in decision-making by allowing them to craft their own discipline codes.	4.27	0.77	Always
I demonstrate equality and equity in all classroom operations and instructional activities so they can understand the value of justice and fairness.	4.36	0.73	Always
General Weighted Mean	4.36		Always

Source. Data analysis result of the research

Table 12 shows the teaching methods and strategies of the IPed teachers to localize SDGs. IPed teachers continuously enhance learners' critical reflection on the matters that seriously concern their lifeways and upbringing by connecting the lessons to the societal issues and plight of their ancestry. Also, they frequently design collaborative, real-life, and digital-oriented learning activities to train learners to respond due to society's ever-changing and complex nature. Restoule and Chaw-in-is (2017) mentioned the relevance of hands-on and project-based outputs in improving learners' physical, intellectual, spiritual, and emotional development. Furthermore, IPed teachers frequently ask for the assistance of tribal representatives in teaching topics that reveal the community's aspirations, status, and struggles.

Table 12

Classroom Practices of IPed Teachers in Localizing SDGs in Terms of Teaching Methods and Strategies

Indicative statement	Mean	SD	Verbal description
I ask tribal representatives to become my teaching assistants in discussing some classroom topics that house issues and concerns related to the development of indigenous communities.	3.52	1.13	Frequent
I connect all lectures and topics to real-life situations and to the future for the learners to understand the complexity and uncertainty of the contemporary world.	4.11	0.98	Frequent

Indicative statement	Mean	SD	Verbal description
I bring technology-oriented learning tools or digital-based materials to the classroom to assist me in delivering lectures towards reducing the digital divide.	4.01	0.99	Frequent
I connect the lessons to the societal issues and struggles of different people to help indigenous learners become development-oriented individuals even at a young age.	4.22	0.84	Always
I utilize teaching techniques that oblige learners to work collaboratively with other people to develop their sense of responsibility in sustaining a cohesive society.	4.18	0.78	Frequent
General Weighted Mean	4.01		Frequent

Source. Data analysis result of the research

4.2. Analyze the perceptions and experiences of the teachers and other educational stakeholders on the participation, promotion, and practices of IPed-implementing schools in localizing SDGs

Educational stakeholders have specific roles in pursuing a course of development actions that safeguard the indigenous communities' economic viability, environment integrity, education governance, and social sustainability. The shared commitment and knowledge of the IPed teachers and the school stakeholders manifests a promising mutual affiliation to actualize the planned activities to localize the SDGs, benefitting the schools and extending to the broader community. The themes generated from the FGD and semi-structured interviews were further consolidated as shown in the discussion below:

4.2.1. On participation in Localization of SDGs

Participants emphasized the relevance of the stakeholders to pursue collaborative action for the improvement of both the school and the community. The commitment of the stakeholders provides a long-lasting impact on the achievement of a sustainable education toward securing the future of the whole community as it systematically drives the exchange of resources. Likewise, the partnership existing between various entities enriches the mechanisms for risk management and responsibility sharing towards the mobilization of SDGs. As Bowen (2005) stated, the core tenet of stakeholder participation and collaboration is that it fosters community-driven development and boosts resource productivity.

Results revealed that the distribution of resources becomes more equitable and innovative as the multi-stakeholder partnership, private sectors in particular, generates more engagements in the process of localization of SDGs. At the same time, IPed teachers consistently participate in various engagements that aim to widen opportunities for the indigenous communities and reduce their vulnerabilities and potential risks due to marginalization. These engagements include, but are not limited to, providing employment opportunities, sponsoring digital tools and modern school equipment, innovating instructional approaches, building adequate water, sanitation, and hygiene (WASH) facilities, looking for program sponsorships, and extending social and health services. The development of programs to meet community needs is facilitated by the exchange of resources and innovative ideas through a method and framework for agencies, institutions, and communities to collaborate on challenges relevant to the community (Giachello et al., 2007).

In return, IPed teachers mentioned getting the stakeholders involved in school planning and development, such as bridging the gap in reading comprehension. Some teachers were part of the community meetings, especially when conducting annual celebrations, budgeting the Special Education Fund (SEF), crafting climate change policy, preserving cultural heritage, and deciding on community development activities. Similarly, in community development activities, it was underscored in the study by xxx that rural-based teachers are prominently involved in literacy programs, adult literacy, improvement of sanitation conditions, and gender education (Ntini, 2006).

4.2.2. On the promotion of localization of SDGs

Strengthening commitment to SDGs implementation requires a good promotion that strongly contributes to its actualization. The number of people with enough knowledge of the SDGs, though not guaranteed participation, may serve as an initial step to changing an individual's mindset towards sustainable living. Participants stated that social media has been utilized to inform people about the programs and services available for proactively meeting the community's needs. They also create digital content that keeps people updated with society's status and potential risks and threats that might endanger their lives. For instance, through the use of Facebook, they share and promote preventive measures to be observed during the events of man-made or natural disasters, or any catastrophic events that may result in a high number of casualties. Since social media is a market of ideas, IPed teachers used its features and applications to reach many people and campaign for the various causes and community drives initiated by the schools. Social media usage goes beyond simply promoting sustainable development; it also includes how it brings like-minded people together and inspires them to take collective action (Balaswamy & Palvai, 2017).

In addition, participants accentuated that participation in a public forum serves as a good venue to critically discuss some issues and concerns that deal with public welfare and inclusive development. IPed teachers mentioned that they are invited to attend community meetings to provide insights and expert views about the issues being discussed. Likewise, the educational stakeholders collectively shared that they have been invited by the IPed-implementing schools every time to promote new school-based projects or policy policies for support and assistance in its realization. These projects usually include solid waste management, the establishment of reading centers, disaster preparedness, ancestral domain conservation, and cultural preservation. To commence the execution of the said projects, teachers still ask for consent from the tribal leaders and elders to uphold their rights to self-governance and social justice. Securing permission is also a way to promote the project to the whole community, as they have high respect for their indigenous political structures. These findings were corroborated by Arefaine (2012), who explained the relevance of Community Forum on local democracy and accountability as it provides opportunities for residents to actively participate in conversations important to their daily lives. The fora offer chances for individuals, members of Civil Society Organizations (CSOs), corporate leaders, local institutions, and other relevant agencies to come together, analyze issues, and suggest solutions.

4.2.3. On practices for the localization of SDGs

To successfully localize the SDGs in schools, IPed teachers consistently observed valuable practices that capacitate the learners to contribute to sustainable development even at a younger age. The early inculcation of its measures to learners would also help them enhance their development-oriented mindset towards achieving a prosperous future. For instance, the DepEd has launched the "Gulayan sa Paaralan" project under the National Greening Program to

reduce malnutrition and hunger among learners. More than that, participants emphasized that this practice also combats food insecurity and increases the schooling rate as one of the main reasons for the high drop-out rate is hunger. Learners would also notice the relevance of self-help food production on responsible consumption, climate change adaptation, and environmental protection. Through development program activities, students were given the opportunities to become more engaged in tackling and addressing community problems (Afzal & Hussain, 2020).

Aside from that, one of the ways to foster inclusive societies and peaceful living is the protection of the cultural integrity of the indigenous communities. The lifeways and worldviews are deeply rooted in their unique culture and history, which serve as their moral compass for protecting their ancestral lineage. Consequently, IPed teachers created a number of indigenized learning materials that illustrate their own stories and express their traditional knowledge using their mother tongue. They also practiced relational teaching by allowing learners to appreciate their ancestral domain as their real-life classroom and value their local products as enablers of cultural protection and economic viability. A country's basic education should recognize and promote the rights and welfare of indigenous peoples to enable them to face various social realities and challenges; such a system must be inclusive of minority learners and respectful of their rights (Victor & Yano, 2016).

Furthermore, it was also emphasized in e-interviews that learners have the freedom to decide on the classroom policies and discipline codes according to their choices. They are exposed to teaching strategies anchored on real-life contexts in which learners can easily apply and test the learned knowledge. IPed teachers also shared that they usually invite tribal leaders before the opening of classes to conduct rituals for protection and guidance in all their endeavors. They also ask them to share inspiring stories and cultural knowledge during celebrations and school activities. In relation to the study by Amuthenu (2023), it was emphasized that to help marginalized groups feel accepted and a part of society, teachers are expected to have a deep understanding of cultural diversity and to develop multicultural teaching materials that take into account the cultural backgrounds of their students. This will help communities coexist harmoniously in a multicultural society.

4.3. Examine the extent of convergence and divergence of quantitative and qualitative results

Table 13 shows the convergence of both sets of data. Results indicated that IPed-implementing schools help the government localize the SDGs through participation, promotion, and practices that systematically and inclusively catalyze actions for its achievement. The findings also confirmed that IPed-implementing schools, despite being located in hard-reached areas and resource-challenged institutions, are still partners of the government in pursuing courses of action that address sustainability issues and concerns through multi-stakeholder and cross-sectoral partnerships. They also offer and invest philanthropic and intellectual capital through school- and classroom-level programs and projects to facilitate positive changes towards sustainable public welfare and reduce vulnerabilities. In connection, Okitasari et al. (2021) stated that the success of achieving the SDGs will be significantly influenced by the degree and rate at which nations and local stakeholders build more sustainable and inclusive multi-stakeholder partnership structures.

Furthermore, it was revealed in the FGDs that even though IPed teachers may not have a solid knowledge of SDGs, they have their own ways of localizing the provisions and the targets of the 2023 SDGs Agenda. Indeed, localizing of SDGs at the school level is an empowering

movement to shift the roles of indigenous communities from the periphery to the center as they take their roles toward sustainable living. As explained by xxx, integrating SDGS at the school level catalyzes achieving other global goals by fostering social transformation through the development of knowledge, values, and behaviors that point the way to a sustainable future (Ferrer-Estévez & Chalmeta, 2021).

Table 13

Merged Results of Quantitative and Qualitative

Convergence questions	Quantitative results	Qualitative results	Relationship
Did the IPed-implementing Schools participate in localizing SDGs?	Yes	Yes	Convergence
Did the IPed-implementing Schools promote SDGs?	Yes	Yes	Convergence
Did the IPed-implementing Schools localize SDGs through classroom practices?	Yes	Yes	Convergence

Source. Data analysis result of the research

5. Conclusion

Localization of SDGs in the IPed-implementing schools is indeed challenging. As an initial participation in the SDGs localization procedures, IPed teachers consistently extended efforts in finding donors and sponsors to advance the learning materials used in the classroom. They initiated a feeding program drive to reduce the rate of malnutrition and hunger and provided medical supplements since health centers are non-existent in some barangays. In terms of promotion, the IPed teachers made use of social media to disseminate information regarding the rich culture and history of the community. To mobilize the objectives of SDGs in the community, securing trust and loyalty through rapport building and consent-seeking has been prioritized by the IPed teachers.

Valuing equity and equality in classroom activities has been the topmost consideration when designing instructional tools, assessing learning outcomes, managing classrooms, and applying teaching strategies. Hence, IPed teachers adhered to the fundamental human rights of the IPs and challenged hegemonic standards by connecting the lessons with societal issues and struggles. Additionally, establishing collaboration and partnership with the private sector is the most feasible way to fill the gap in providing quality education. The support given by the said groups may reduce the problem of malnutrition, lack of learning materials, and healthcare services. It was also noted that social media has been used for cultural preservation. Furthermore, IPed teachers used critical social pedagogy to address the long-term struggles and gloom-ridden situations of IPs.

The convergence of both quantitative and qualitative data results means that IPed teachers have a commendable goal orientation and high commitment to empowering the IPs by making them and themselves active participants and contributors to the attainment of SDGs.

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